

BM1 — Lesson 4: Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

 **Theme:** Prayer, The First Resort/Praise in Midnight Moments

 **Background Text:** Acts 16:16–34; Isaiah 26:3; Philippians 4:6–7

 **Key Verse :** Acts 16:25–26 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone’s bonds were loosened.”

 **Appetizer – Praise in the Darkest Hour, Acts 16:25; Isaiah 26:3 (WEB)**

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them.”

“You will keep whoever’s mind is steadfast in perfect peace, because he trusts in you.”

It was the darkest hour—a time that should have been filled with despair. Instead, it became a moment of praise and rejoicing. Paul and Silas were in chains, yet their mouths were full of worship. Their situation said “panic,” but their spirit chose “praise.”

 **CST Thought**

God promises perfect peace to those who fix their minds on Him. His peace is not the absence of trouble, but a deep, enduring confidence in His unchanging nature. In the midnight of life’s trials, when everything feels shut in and locked down, praise can turn despair into deliverance.

 **Reflection Question**

When has God given you peace when everything around you said panic?

Main Course – Power in the Praises

Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24, 31 (WEB)

²²The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴who, having received such a charge, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks.”

³¹They said, ‘Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.’

CST Commentary

Paul and Silas were not in prison for committing a crime—they were there for preaching salvation through Jesus Christ: *“Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved.”* They were beaten, humiliated, and locked up for doing what was right—yet they didn’t lose faith. Your weakest, worst moment can become your greatest testament to the power of God. (Remember Jesus in the Garden of Gethsemane.)

Reflection Question

What would your praise sound like if it echoed in the middle of your pain?

Bite 2 – Peace That Passes Understanding, Acts 16:25–26 (WEB)

25 But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. 26 Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone’s bonds were loosened.”

CST Commentary

It’s amazing what can happen when you keep your mind stayed on Him (see Isaiah 26:3). Their voices turned a prison into a sanctuary, and their pain became a praise report. Sometimes your midnight melody becomes someone else’s breakthrough song. Certain songs, like *“Holy Forever”* by CeCe Winans, strengthen my heart when life feels heavy because they lift my focus off the problem and onto His power.

Reflection Question

What worship song or prayer brings you back to peace when life feels heavy?

Bite 3 – Contagious Praise, Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:27–30 (WEB)

²⁷ The jailer, being roused out of sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, ‘Don’t harm yourself, for we are all here!’ ²⁹ He called for lights and sprang in, and, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰ and brought them out and said, ‘Sirs, what must I do to be saved?’

CST Thought

Paul and Silas’s praise didn’t just free them—it freed everyone in earshot. That’s the power of contagious worship: when you lift up Jesus, the chains fall off everyone near you. Your faith can set an atmosphere that invites others into freedom.

Reflection Question

Who has been influenced by your praise or perseverance?

Dessert – Joy Unspeakable Joy, Acts 16:31–34 (WEB)

³¹ They said, ‘Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.’
³² They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house. ³³ He took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household. ³⁴ He brought them up into his house, and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, with all his household, having believed in God.”

CST Commentary

Praise is contagious, and faith is transferable. Paul and Silas's obedience led to the warden's family's salvation. What began as a night of pain ended in joy—unspeakable joy.

To-Go Box

- When you choose praise over panic, God moves immediately.
- He can still shake foundations, open doors, and loose chains—not just yours, but everyone within reach of your faith.
- No matter what the problem, Jesus will always be the answer.

Carry this truth into every season:

Your midnight praise can become somebody else's morning miracle.

Prayer

“Lord Jesus, Thank You for being with us in our midnight moments. Teach us to choose praise over panic and to trust that You are working even when we cannot see it. Let our worship create an atmosphere where others can experience freedom, salvation, and joy. Use our pain as a platform for Your power. In Your name we pray, amen.”

Reflection & Group Discussion

1. When has God used a hard season in your life to encourage someone else?

2. What is one “midnight situation” you need to surrender to God in praise right now?

3. Who comes to mind when you think about someone who needs to “hear” your praise?

Group Reflection

Sometimes when the Spirit prompts you to shout or praise, it's not just for you. Someone within earshot might need that breakthrough. Glory be to God for every chain that falls when we praise.

Notes Page — Group Discussion & Personal Study
